BackFromTheDed: Networking - Beginner

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Description

The players will be provided with a .pcap file. This .pcap file will describe the exchange of an image over http. They will have to find the image hidden within the .pcap file and follow it to find the message hidden in its reference. These clues point towards the work of Pierre-Olivier Nantel, and the players will have to find the flag, a secret phrase related to Pierre-Olivier Nantel's work on Watch Dogs 2. This challenge will combine networking knowledge with lateral thinking to find the source of the references in the embedded image.

Github Path: Path to github once it has been added to the repo

Prompt

I was working with some old hardware that I found in a bin. I couldn't get the desktop to display but I was able to record the system's attempt to pass me some information when I connected remotely. If you can find what's hiding beneath this data, and figure out where it leads, you'll find what you're looking for.

Download: [DOWNLOAD LINK]

Hints

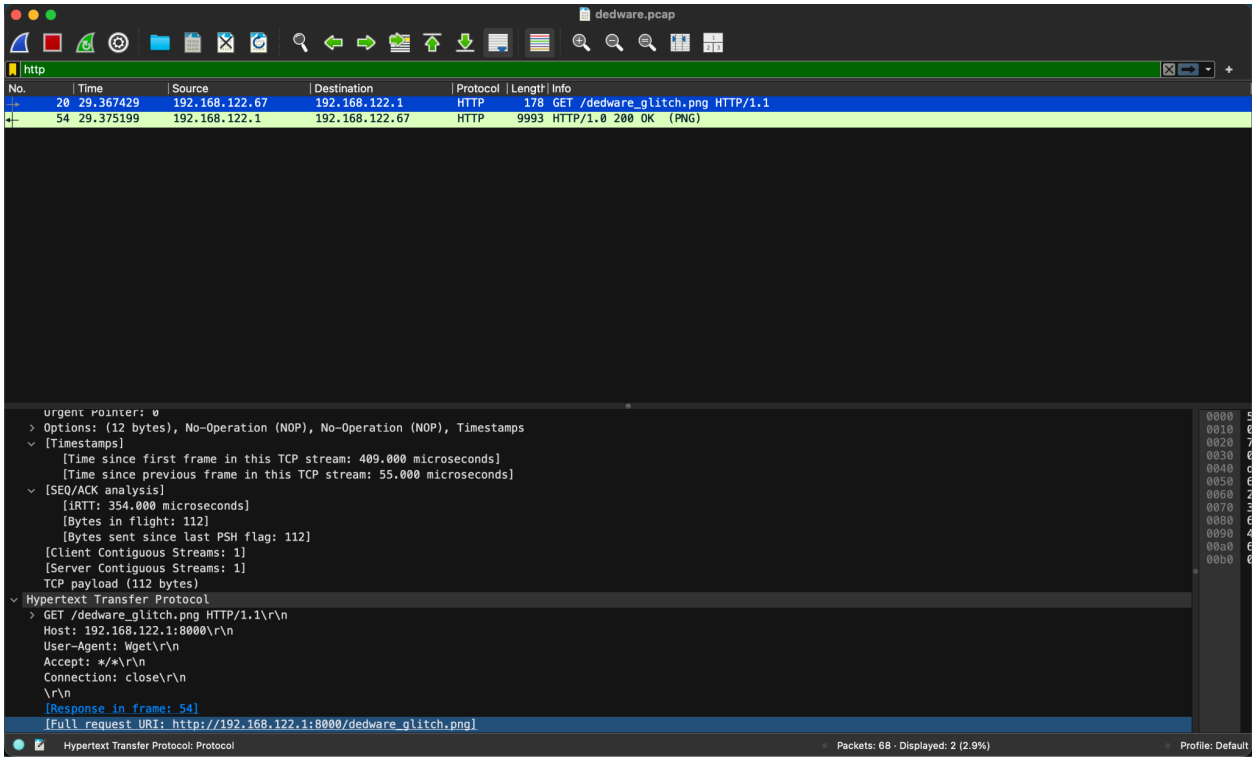
1. Wireshark can pull files straight out of HTTP traffic, look at the packets. What is found in one packet that is not found in others?

2. The image isn't the destination. Check what's embedded in the file beyond the pixels.
3. The metadata names a person and a game they worked on. Search for their professional portfolio, Frankenstein is holding your flag.

Solution

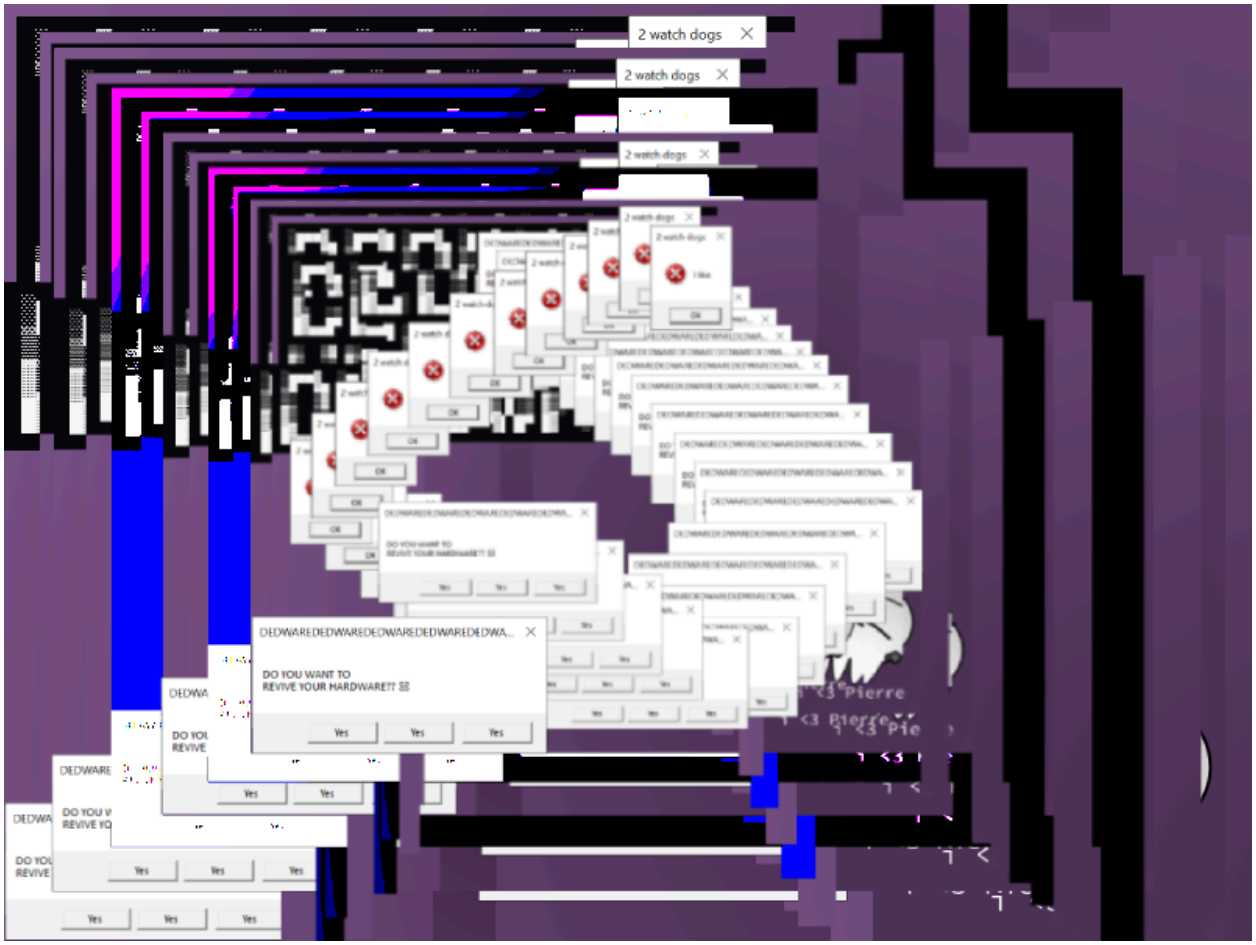
1. The player will be presented with a .pcap file. Analysis of this file in a program like wireshark reveals some specific network traffic.

2. The player may notice the presence of only a few http packets. Filtering for these will reveal an interesting interaction, where a single .png file is passed from one device to another over http.

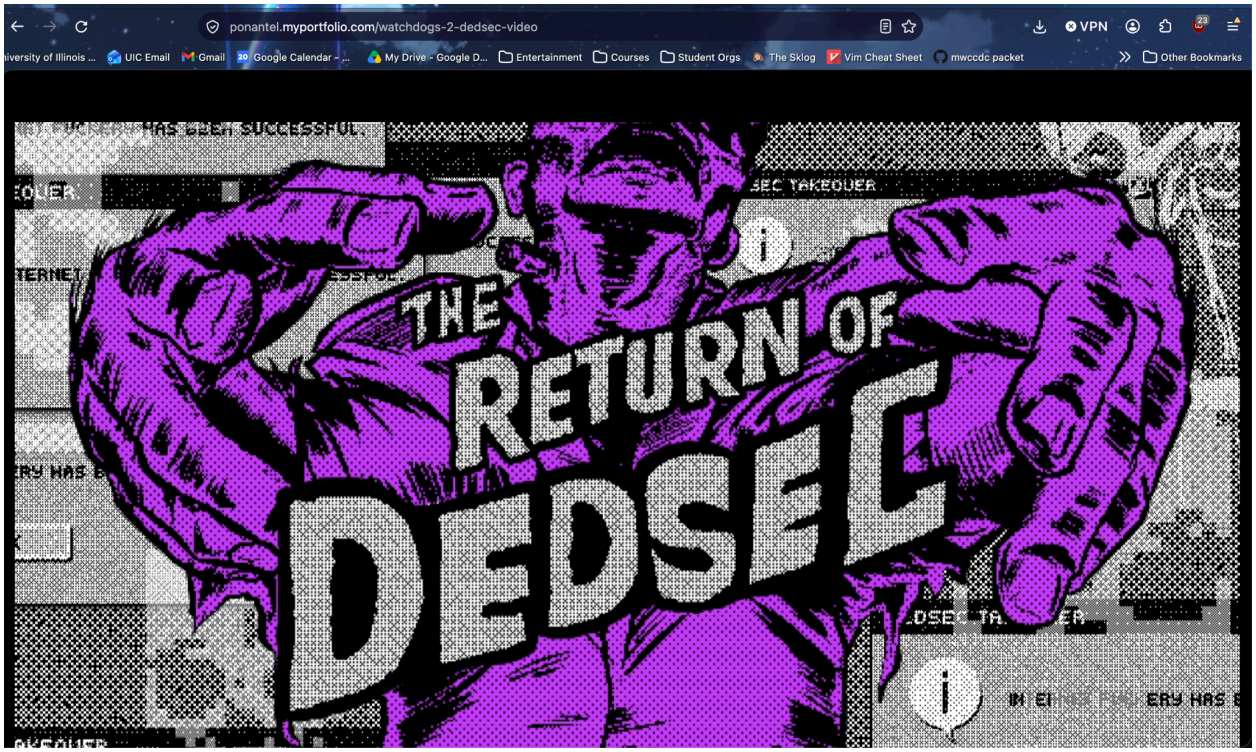


3. Once the .png file is extracted, the player can observe it and try to decipher what it is referring to. There are

hints in the exif data pointing to the image relating to a game, and there is data in the exif indicating what the form of the flag is, 5 words, all caps, and underscores instead of spaces.



4. Looking up any relevant information presented in or adjacent to the image, and using any identifying info in the image, the player may find the work of Pierre-Olivier Nantel, an Art Director who worked on the Ubisoft game Watch Dogs 2 in addition to many others. Hints in and around the challenge will guide them towards a particular image of Frankenstein's monster holding the words "RETURN OF THE DEDSEC"



Flag

flame{THE_RETURN_OF_THE_DEDSEC}